

Local Setup

From a fresh clone to a running app with usable data, then the test suites.

If you only read one thing

Copy `.env.example` to `.env`, fill in `SESSION_SECRET`, and change nothing else. Everything else already points at the local Docker Postgres and at the stub auth and email providers, so no external service is needed.

1 Prerequisites

Tool	Version	Where it's pinned
Node	20+	Nowhere — README prose only. No <code>engines</code> field, no <code>.nvmrc</code> .
pnpm	9+	Implied by <code>pnpm-lock.yaml</code> (<code>lockfileVersion: 9.0</code>)
Docker	any recent	Optional — see §7
Postgres	17 via Docker, 13+ otherwise	<code>docker-compose.yml</code> pins <code>postgres:17-alpine</code>

Node and pnpm are **not** actually pinned in the repo. If a version-drift bug ever bites, that missing `engines` field is why.

2 The `.env`

```
cp .env.example .env
```

`.env.example` ships in a **deliberately non-booting state**. `SESSION_SECRET` is empty so that `z.string().min(32)` fails and the app refuses to start. That is the one line you must fill:

```
openssl rand -base64 48
```

```
SESSION_SECRET=<the 48-byte string from above>
```

Everything else in the example file already works as shipped:

Variable	Default	Why it's fine
<code>DATABASE_URL</code>	<code>postgres://van:van@localhost:5433/van_reservation</code>	Matches <code>docker-compose.yml</code> exactly
<code>TEST_DATABASE_URL</code>	<code>.../van_reservation_test</code>	Auto-created on first integration run
<code>AUTH_MODE</code>	stub — the example's value, not a schema fallback	No CGS credentials needed. The schema has no default, so deleting the line stops the app booting rather than quietly selecting the stub
<code>EMAIL_MODE</code>	stub	No AWS needed
<code>DISPATCH_SECRET</code>	blank	Optional; blank makes the sweeper 404 by design

`NODE_ENV` defaults to `development` when unset. Leave it alone locally.

Do not add `ROSTER_ALLOWLIST` or `ROSTER_ALLOW_ALL_WHEN_EMPTY`. Older notes describe them as a sign-in gate. They do not exist in the schema and setting them does nothing. There is no eligibility allowlist for associates — any identity the provider resolves is admitted, and `admin_whitelist` only decides who additionally gets `admin_support`. See [domain §2](#).

DATABASE_URL vs the DB_* parts

Two forms. `DATABASE_URL` set directly is what the example ships. Alternatively leave it blank and set `DB_HOST`, `DB_PORT`, `DB_NAME`, `DB_USER`, `DB_PASSWORD` and the app composes the URL — only when host, name, and user are all present.

`DATABASE_URL` always wins when set. The sharp edge:

dotenv never overrides a variable your shell already exports. A `DATABASE_URL` inherited from your shell silently beats every `DB_*` value in `.env`. Before debugging a connection that points somewhere unexpected, run `echo "$DATABASE_URL"`.

3 First run

Run these in order. The order matters — see the note after the block.

```
pnpm install
pnpm db:up      # Postgres 17 on host port 5433
pnpm db:migrate # all migrations
pnpm db:codegen # regenerate src/modules/db/types.d.ts from the live schema
pnpm db:seed    # admin whitelist + client fleet roster
pnpm db:seed:dev # sample reservations (dev only)
pnpm dev        # http://localhost:3000
```

Step	What it does	If it fails
<code>db:up</code>	Postgres on 5433 , healthchecked every 5s	Port 5433 already bound — usually a stale container or another local Postgres
<code>db:migrate</code>	Schema only, fast	On a database with existing data, the van/rental CHECK constraints validate against existing rows
<code>db:codegen</code>	Reads the live schema	Needs a reachable <code>DATABASE_URL</code> . With <code>DB_SCHEMA</code> set, needs <code>--default-schema</code> passed by hand (see §7)
<code>db:seed</code>	Upserts 9 whitelist rows and the client fleet (8 drivers, 4 vans)	Requires migrations first — it reads <code>roster_events</code>
<code>db:seed:dev</code>	Sample reservations and people	Refuses to run when <code>NODE_ENV=production</code>
<code>dev</code>	<code>next dev</code>	Empty/short <code>SESSION_SECRET</code> , or Postgres not up

`db:seed:dev` truncates `drivers` and `vans` before loading its own fixtures. So after the documented order above you have the `dev` fleet — 5 drivers, 4 vans — not the client's 8-driver roster that `db:seed` just inserted. That is fine for local work, but it means the `fleet_roster` seed is effectively for production only. If you specifically need the real client fleet locally, run `db:seed` and skip `db:seed:dev`, accepting that you will then have no reservations to look at.

`db:seed` is production-safe and convergent — neither of its two seeds checks `NODE_ENV`, and both are designed to be re-run. `db:seed:dev` truncates and is gated against production.

4 Signing in

With `AUTH_MODE=stub`, the password is ignored entirely. The stub never reads it; the Domain ID alone selects a fixture identity. Type anything.

Two doors, and the door decides your role:

- `/login` — always gives you `associate`, even if you are whitelisted.
- `/admin/login` — requires `admin_support` and 403s otherwise.

So a whitelisted admin can deliberately sign in at `/login` to use the app as a requestor.

Start here

Domain ID	Who	Sign in at	You get
AM65108	Arielle Jimera	/login	A requestor session holding 5 of the 8 canonical reservations, plus roughly a sixth of the generated year
AG80389	Ruwi Joy Eribal	/admin/login	Admin, and a <code>super_admin</code> — the only role that sees <code>/roster</code> 's Admins tab
AB12345	Juan Dela Cruz	/login	A requestor with no bookings — the empty state

`AM65108` is also an `ADMIN_WHITELIST_SEED` row with `super_admin: true`, and that does **not** leak into the `/login` session: `authenticate` sets `role = portal ≡ "admin" ?`

`"admin_support" : "associate" ( service.ts:91 )`, and middleware gates every admin route on `role`. The session still carries `superAdmin: true`, but nothing reachable from the requestor side reads it. So this is a real associate view, and the same Domain ID at `/admin/login` is a real admin one.

The other three canonical reservations belong to `Dizon, Marco`, `Reyes, Kaye` and `Salcedo, Liza`, and the generated dashboard rows draw from a six-person pool (`generated.ts:41-48`). None of those people are in `dev-identities.ts`, so nobody can sign in as them to see their own trips.

Every stub identity

Domain ID	Name	Role	Site	super_admin
AG80389	Ruwi Joy Eribal	admin_support	all	yes
AM65108	Arielle Jimera	admin_support	all	yes
AM37315	Norlen Denonong	admin_support	manila	no
AL12138	Zarra Crist Bartolo	admin_support	manila	no
AH85664	Sharon Gemma Lim	admin_support	manila	no
AM03146	Jezreel Mariz Gromia	admin_support	iloilo	no
AL95338	Ivy Balandra	admin_support	iloilo	no
AH44229	Angel Grace Mateo	admin_support	iloilo	no
AJ40001	Aishki Hyamero	admin_support	all	no — test account, not staff
AB12345	Juan Dela Cruz	associate	—	—
CD67890	Maria Santos	associate	—	—

Roles only take effect **after** `pnpm db:seed` has populated `admin_whitelist`. Before that, every Domain ID resolves to `associate` and `/admin/login` rejects everyone.

Two Domain IDs that older docs suggest — `AJ29104` and `IB10001` — do not exist as identities and will fail to authenticate. `AJ29104` survives only as an embedded passenger *name* in seed fixtures.

What you can reach

Route gating lives in `src/middleware.ts`.

- **Admin-only:** `/dashboard`, `/master-list`, `/calendar`, `/reports`, `/drivers`, `/audit-logs`, `/roster`. A non-admin session is redirected to `/not-authorized?reason=role`.
- **Any session:** `/`, `/book`, `/manage`. Admins can visit these too — one person can be both a requestor and an admin.
- **No session:** redirected to `/login`, or `/admin/login` if the target was an admin path.

End-to-end check: sign in at `/admin/login` as `AG80389`, confirm `/master-list` and `/calendar` render seeded reservations, and confirm `/roster` shows an Admins tab. If reservations are missing, `db:seed:dev` did not run.

5 Tests

	pnpm test	pnpm test:int
Matches	src/**/*.test.{ts,tsx}, excluding *.int.test.ts	src/**/*.int.test.ts
Files today	81	24
Needs Postgres	no	yes
Parallelism	default	serial (<code>fileParallelism: false</code>)
Timeout	default	20s

Integration tests are self-bootstrapping. No manual `createdb`. The global setup connects to `TEST_DATABASE_URL`, and only if that fails does it open the `postgres` maintenance database and create the test database, then runs migrations once.

Before any of that it **refuses to run** if `TEST_DATABASE_URL` is unset, equals `DATABASE_URL`, or does not contain the substring `test` — a guard against wiping your dev database.

Per-test isolation is transaction rollback, not per-schema: `withRollback` runs the test inside a transaction and then unconditionally aborts it with a sentinel error. Tests leave no residue.

Per-schema isolation (`DB_SCHEMA`) is a *different* layer, for concurrent developers sharing one server — see §7.

`VITE_CONFIG_NATIVE_IGNORE_WARNING=true` is set inline in the test scripts. Nothing in this repo explains why; it appears to suppress a Vitest-internal warning about the native config loader.

6 Other commands

Command	Does	Run it
<code>pnpm lint</code>	<code>biome check</code>	Before every commit
<code>pnpm format</code>	<code>biome format --write</code>	To auto-fix
<code>pnpm typecheck</code>	<code>tsc --noEmit</code>	Before every commit
<code>pnpm db:migrate:make <name></code>	Scaffolds a timestamped migration	For any schema change
<code>pnpm db:codegen</code>	Regenerates <code>types.d.ts</code> from the live schema	After every migration
<code>pnpm db:down</code>	Stops the container; the data volume survives	When you're done
<code>pnpm build / pnpm start</code>	Production build and serve	Before a deploy

7 Using a database you don't own

Docker is optional; any Postgres 13+ works.

Leave `DATABASE_URL` and `TEST_DATABASE_URL` blank and set the parts instead: `DB_HOST`, `DB_PORT`, `DB_NAME`, `DB_USER`, `DB_PASSWORD`.

`DB_SCHEMA` puts your tables in a named schema instead of `public`, applied as a libpq startup option (`?options=-c search_path=...`), so every unqualified query and migration resolves inside it. This is what lets integration tests run without `CREATE DATABASE` rights: with `DB_SCHEMA` set, tests use a `<schema>_test` sibling `schema` in the same database rather than a separate database.

`DB_SSLMODE=no-verify` for a private CA. `require` will fail against an untrusted certificate — `pg` treats `require` as verify-full.

Codegen needs the schema told separately, and the npm script does not pass it:

```
pnpm exec kysely-codegen --dialect postgres \  
  --out-file ./src/modules/db/types.d.ts --default-schema <schema>
```


8 Things that will confuse you

An empty `SESSION_SECRET` fails twice, deliberately. `env.ts` requires 32+ characters, and `src/middleware.ts` carries its own independent length check. Without the second one, a too-short secret would verify JWTs fine at the edge while `env()` rejected it everywhere else — the app would boot green and every non-edge route would 500 on its first request.

A real `cgsauth` login against an unseeded database shows empty pages. `AUTH_MODE=cgsauth` admits any identity the CGS service authenticates, but every reservation, driver, and van on screen comes from the seeds. Correctly authenticated users, zero rows anywhere. Reads exactly like a broken read path; it isn't.

Mail in stub mode goes nowhere while reporting success. The stub queues, renders, and marks every notification `sent` in `notification_outbox`. The dispatcher reports success. Nothing is delivered. The only visibility is a dev console line:

```
[email:stub] → someone@example.com · cc: a, b · Subject (stub-3)
```

An environment that never sets `EMAIL_MODE=ses` looks healthy in every log and every table while delivering nothing. This is why `EMAIL_MODE` defaults to `stub` but the stub *refuses to construct in production*.

`/roster`'s Admins tab is invisible until `pnpm db:seed` runs. `super_admin` lives only on whitelist rows, so an unseeded database has no holders — and the tab is hidden even from the person the seed would have made one. Fail-closed by design, easy to mistake for a bug.

`/api/internal/dispatch-outbox` 404s by default. It needs `DISPATCH_SECRET` (16+ chars). You don't need it for local work — the post-response `after()` trigger still delivers. See [operations](#).

See also

- [Domain rules](#) — the business rules
- [Architecture](#) — how the code is laid out
- [Operations](#) — environment, deploy, runbook
- [Email and notifications](#) — the notification pipeline and the templates